

THE NOHO RAG: EPISODE 204
VIRUS SCARE

Written by

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FADE IN:

INT. WRITER'S ROOM - DAY

BOB fidgets with items on shelves, as he does. Then reaches for a tissue just in time to catch a massive SNEEZE.

OLIVIA is pecking away at her keyboard, she turns when Bob sneezes.

OLIVIA
Coming down with something?

BOB
(clearly stuffy)
Oh no, I'm fine!
(beat)
Never felt better!

OLIVIA
Oh good, because if you had
whatever's going around, I'd hope
you would have the good sense to
stay home.

BOB
Well, I'm not sick.
(beat)
I can't be sick.
(beat)
This weekend is The twenty sixteen
Pacific Lifestyle and Leisure show.

Olivia stares at Bob blankly.

Bob scoffs.

BOB (CONT'D)
It's only this region's premiere
foodie and fun expo!
(beat)
I go every year!

Olivia stares blankly at Bob.

BOB (CONT'D)
(to himself)
I can't be sick.

Bob blows his nose again or coughs.

BOB (CONT'D)
I'm **not** sick.

CUT TO:

TITLE CARD

INT. NEWS DESK

Dane and Kelly Mae rock the news:

KELLY MAE
Good evening, I'm Kelly Mae
Greenblatt.

DANE
And I'm Dane Argyle.
(beat)
VIRUS SCARE!
(beat)
Do you have it? You might!

KELLY MAE
That's right, NoHo citizens are in
the grips of the extremely
contagious Acute Pneumococcal
Alpaca Fever.

DANE
This newly discovered communicative
and antibiotic-resistant disease
spreads fast and incubates in the
system for three weeks.

CUT TO:

INT. NEWS DESK - BEHIND THE CAMERA

Bob's eyes grow wide.

CUT TO:

KELLY MAE
For those unfamiliar with the
symptoms. It begins similar to a
common cold.
(beat)
Sniffling.

CUT TO:

INT. NEWS DESK - BEHIND THE CAMERA

Bob sniffles.

CUT TO:

INT. NEWS DESK

KELLY MAE

Coughing.

CUT TO:

INT. NEWS DESK - BEHIND THE CAMERA

Bob first looks around and sheepishly coughs.

CUT TO:

INT. NEWS DESK

KELLY MAE

And projectile vomiting.

CUT TO:

INT. NEWS DESK - BEHIND THE CAMERA

Bob's eyes grow as wide as saucers as he grips his script. He nervously grabs his chest/stomach and test heaves with concerned eyes.

CUT TO:

INT. NEWS DESK

DANE

The CDC is now investigating the root cause and exploring immunization options because while this is currently regional, it is feared it may soon spread across the nation.

(beat)

Doctor Elias Harold of the CDC released this statement earlier today.

INT. CDC STATEMENT PACKAGE - ON GREEN

Standard trappings of a press conference.

DOCTOR ELIAS HAROLD stands at the podium in a LAB COAT.

ELIAS

We are uncertain at this time how
this disease jumped from the Alpaca
to humans. We now have our smartest
minds working around the clock
searching for a cure.

(beat)

In the meantime, it is important to
avoid human contact with people
exhibiting the listed symptoms.

(beat)

Those suffering are contagious for
three weeks from onset. And
remember this is an airborne
disease. Which means it can be
spread without direct contact.

Peanut gallery erupts. Elias calms the crowd.

ELIAS (CONT'D)

This is all the information we have
at this time.

(beat)

But, if you feel ill and you have
plans...

(beat)

Cancel them and stay home.

CUT TO:

INT. NEWS DESK - BEHIND THE CAMERA

Bob is noticeably sweating.

BOB

Oh no...

CUT TO:

INT. NEWS DESK

DANE

Scary stuff there, KM.

(beat)

(MORE)

DANE (CONT'D)
And here I thought I'd only ever
see acute alpaca at the petting
zoo.

Kelly Mae nods.

KELLY MAE
I know where I'll be this
weekend...
(beat)
Staying inside.
(beat)
We'll be right back after these
messages.

The Paraflix commercial audio plays in the background while
Kelly Mae and Dane sit at the desk with the green screen
clearly visible.

Bob stands staring into the middle distance, sweating.

Dane chats with Kelly Mae.

DANE
I tell you, these animal
illnesses...
(beat)
If it's not swine, it's bird. Flu,
fever. Something's gonna wipe out
the human race.
(beat)
Might as well be the majestic
alpaca.

Dane looks over to Bob. Dane scrutinizes Bob standing
nervously, sweating.

DANE (CONT'D)
So Bob, what do you got going on
this weekend?

Bob slowly snaps to, and recognizes Dane's question.

BOB
Well, I, uh...
(beat)
Have, uh...
(beat)
A leisure and-

Bob holds in a heave.

BOB (CONT'D)
Lifestyle expo.
(beat)
It's uh...

Bob heaves again.

BOB (CONT'D)
This region's premiere foodie and
fun...

Dane's attention turns to the feed.

DANE
Hold that thought, Bob!
(beat)
The new comptroller campaign
commercials are on!

CUT TO:

EXT. PARK - EUGENE'S AD - DAY

EUGENE KNOTTS walks through a grassy knoll and comes to a stop with a garbage can in the mid background. Bucolic MUSIC plays.

EUGENE
Hello there, I'm Eugene Knotts,
retired pediatrician.
(beat)
And I'm running for your vote as
NoHo's next comptroller.
(beat)
If you're like me. You love a good
park day.
(beat)
But NoHo's parks are in need of a
little revitalization.
(beat)
We've been kicking that can down
the road for far too long.

Eugene laughs.

A BUM wanders into the background of the shot and begins rummaging in the garbage can. Eugene doesn't notice.

EUGENE (CONT'D)
That's why I'm releasing my plan to
reinvigorate NoHo's parks and
walking trails.
(beat)
(MORE)

EUGENE (CONT'D)
 As your comptroller I will take the
 necessary steps to make our
 existing parks safe.
 (beat)
 And add a few more parks as we
 skeedaddle into the future!

The BUM begins eliciting the same symptoms as described
 earlier. Eugene turns back to address the bum.

EUGENE (CONT'D)
 (to Bum)
 Neighbor.

Eugene looks back to the camera.

EUGENE (CONT'D)
 Walk with me, NoHo, won't you?

ONSCREEN: Standard "This Commercial Paid For" information.

CUT TO:

EXT. NORTH VICTORY - BLAKE'S AD - DAY

Blake stands in a dilapidated part of town.

BLAKE
 North Victory has been a blemish on
 this beautiful city for as long as
this guy's been around!
 (beat)
 But it doesn't have to be that way
 anymore!
 (beat)
 Sup guys!
 (beat)
 Blake Pearson here, extreme sports
 enthusiast and proud trust fund
 baby!
 (beat)
 I want to be your next comptroller
 because I think North Victory is
 worth saving!
 (beat)
 How? You ask?

CUT TO:

INT. CONSTRUCTION SITE - GREEN SCREEN

BLAKE

BEER!

(beat)

We are standing at ground zero of
the new Cahuenga Valley Brewery,
Restaurant, and entertainment fun
zone!

(beat)

This, of course, is merely stage
one in my comprehensive
revitalization plan to turn blight
into a blast!

(beat)

If elected, I will flex the power
of comptroller and bring other
businesses to North Victory-

(sotto)

Provided they have signed my
commitment pledge...

(beat)

Together, we will make NoHo great
again!

(beat)

This Ad paid for by me!

(sotto)

And just a couple of my friends...

Legalize scrolls at great length across the screen.

BLAKE (CONT'D)

Do I support this message?

(beat)

You tripping? Please...

CUT TO:

TITLE CARD

INT. NEWS DESK

DANE

Welcome back, NoHo.

(beat)

Or... At least those of you who
aren't projectile vomiting.

Kelly Mae bristles.

KELLY MAE

Well that's our show for tonight,
I'm Kelly Mae Greenblatt. Stay safe
out there NoHo.

DANE

And I'm Dane Argyle. Coming up
next: a rerun of the South West
regional Parcheesi championships.
(beat)
Good night and death to Alpacas.

INT. BREAK ROOM - AFTER THE SHOW

Bob is adding honey to his tea. Kelly Mae enters and begins
fidgeting with her own snack.

KELLY MAE

I just know I'm gonna catch this
damn alpaca fever.

Bob instantly tenses.

KELLY MAE (CONT'D)

It happens every time...

(beat)

I'm going to run into some old
friend at the super market, and I'm
gonna have to hug her.

(beat)

Or at the gym.

(beat)

It's coming for me, I can feel it.

(beat)

Then it's three weeks of hell, Bob.

Bob tenses more.

KELLY MAE (CONT'D)

I just never notice the symptoms.

(beat)

And even if I do, it's too late.

(beat)

I mean everybody's sniffing!

Bob sniffles and Kelly Mae's mouth drops open like she just
figured out the killer in a whodunit.

KELLY MAE (CONT'D)

You were coughing during the break!

(beat)

Oh no, Bob.

Bob looks suspect.

KELLY MAE (CONT'D)
Bob, you don't have it...
(beat)
Do you?

BOB
(raspy)
Of course not. Kelly -

Bob heaves.

BOB (CONT'D)
...Mae.
(beat)
I've already got my tickets to the
Pacific Leisure and Lifestyle expo
this weekend.
(beat)
It's food and...
(beat)
And...
(beat)
...fun...

Bob holds still for a second and looks wildly concerned.

KELLY MAE
Bob, if you go to that, you're
going to throw up all the food and
no one's going to have **any** fun.
(beat)
You will be patient zero.
(beat)
And I need to leave, because I
already feel it coming on.

Kelly Mae exits.

Bob is left staring intently into the middle distance. Then
Bob exclaims Wrath-of-Khan style:

BOB
LEISURE!!!

Smash to black.